## PROGRESS

Progress is a general term frequently used by experts to denote betterment or improvement in anything. In economics, the term was used for a long period to show the positive movement in the lives of people and an economy. It had both quantitative and qualitative aspects to it. After a point of time, some economists started using all the three terms—progress, growth and development—interchangeably to mean almost the same thing. But it was only during the three decades of 1960s, 1970s and 1980s that the clear meanings we attach to these terms today, really evolved.[1] The term 'progress' became a general term with no specific meaning in economics or denoting both growth and development. But growth and development were allotted their clear-cut meanings.

## ECONOMIC GROWTH

A term coming from the life sciences, 'growth' in economics means economic growth. An increase in the economic variables over a period of time is – economic growth. The term can be used in an individual case or in the case of an economy or for the whole world. The most important aspect of growth is its *quantifiability* i.e. one can measure it in absolute terms.[2] All the units of measurement may be applied to show it, depending upon the economic variable where the growth is being studied. We have a few examples:

(i) An economy might have been able to see growth in its food production during a decade which could be measured in tonnes.

(ii) Road network growth of an economy might be measured for a decade or any period in miles or kilometres.

(iii) Similarly, the value of the total production of an economy might be measured in currency terms which means the economy is growing.

(iv) Per capita income for an economy might be measured in monetary terms over a period.

We may say that ***economic growth is a quantitative progress.***